



From chatbots to personal assistants: how governance is key to harnessing the power of AI Agents

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ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

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Link to source

- <https://www.forbes.com/sites/jodiecook/2026/03/10/vibe-coding-is-the-biggest-unlock-for-non-technical-founders-right-now/>

Main Findings

- The article explains that artificial intelligence is evolving from simple tools, such as chatbots, into more advanced **AI agents** that can act autonomously, make decisions, and complete tasks with minimal human input. These agents are capable of interacting across systems, learning from data, and executing multi-step actions, making them significantly more powerful than traditional AI tools.
- A central argument of the article is that **autonomy must be intentionally designed and controlled**. Rather than allowing AI agents to operate freely, organizations must carefully define the level of authority these systems have. The article emphasizes that autonomy and control should be treated as key design variables, not afterthoughts.
- Additionally, the article highlights that as AI agents become more integrated into real-world workflows, **governance frameworks are lagging behind technological advancement**, creating risks related to security, accountability, and system reliability.

Broader Implications for Society

- The rise of AI agents has significant implications for society. One major impact is the shift toward **autonomous decision-making systems**, where AI can perform tasks traditionally handled by humans. This can improve efficiency, productivity, and scalability across industries.
- However, the article stresses that increased autonomy also introduces new risks. AI agents can create **unpredictable outcomes**, especially when interacting with multiple systems or other agents. Without proper governance, this could lead to unintended consequences, including security vulnerabilities and ethical concerns.
- Another key implication is the need for **clear accountability**. As AI agents act independently, it becomes more difficult to determine who is responsible for their decisions. This raises important legal and ethical questions about ownership, liability, and trust.
- Overall, the article suggests that society must shift toward a “**governance-first**” **mindset**, ensuring that safeguards, monitoring, and human oversight are built into AI systems from the beginning.

Relevance and Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

- AI agents have strong potential to transform the construction industry, particularly in areas like BIM, VDC, and project management. These systems could act as intelligent assistants that automate workflows, coordinate tasks, and make real-time decisions based on project data.
- For example, AI agents could:
 - Automatically manage **clash detection workflows** and assign coordination issues
 - Optimize **construction schedules and sequencing (4D planning)**
 - Monitor project progress and flag risks in real time
 - Assist with **cost tracking and quantity takeoffs**
- This aligns with the increasing digitization of construction and the use of platforms like BIM and project management software.
- However, the article's emphasis on governance is especially critical in construction. Since projects involve safety, cost, and contractual risks, **uncontrolled AI decision-making could lead to major issues**, such as incorrect coordination decisions or scheduling conflicts.
- Therefore, the construction industry would need to implement strict oversight, ensuring that AI agents support—not replace—human decision-making. This reinforces the importance of **VDC leadership roles evolving into AI oversight and workflow management positions**.